statements, or “Grays,” by IMF executive directors. Our dependent variable is the logged count of Grays submitted by a country or a constituency leader in a given year. Because the data are overdispersed, we take the natural logarithm to normalize the distribution. This analysis replicates results from Carnegie, Clark, and Kaya (2024) appearing in the *Journal of Politics*.

The key independent variable, as in other chapters, is a binary populism measure drawn from Funke, Schularick, and Trebesch (2023). To account for the IMF’s constituency system, where seven powerful members have their own executive directors while others belong to multicountry groupings, we weight this populism measure by a country’s GDP share within its constituency. This reflects the expectation that larger, more influential countries have a greater impact on ED behavior. For robustness, we confirm that unweighted results align with these findings.[12]

A preliminary analysis reveals strong support for our hypothesis. On average, executive directors representing populist-led governments submit 24.4 Grays annually, compared with just 9.9 from nonpopulist counterparts. This difference is statistically significant ($p = 0.000$) and suggests that populist governments engage behind the scenes at the IMF to a much greater extent than nonpopulist governments.